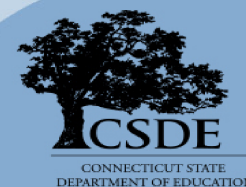


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



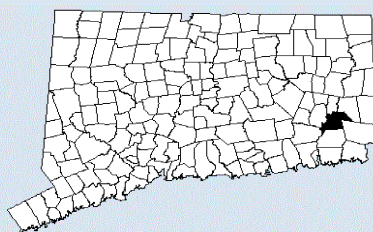
Preston School District

Mr. Roy Seitsinger Jr, Superintendent • 860-889-6098 • <http://www.prestonschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	2
Enrollment	427
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$21,709
Total Expenditures ¹	\$12,743,154

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	207	48.5	48.5
Male	220	51.5	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.3
Asian	11	2.6	5.1
Black or African American	*	*	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	34	8.0	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	17	4.0	4.3
White	353	82.7	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	6	1.4	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	84	19.7	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	62	14.5	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	59	32.2	0	0.0
Male	74	37.0	6	2.6
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	11	32.4	*	*
White	112	36.1	*	*
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	53	44.5	*	*
Students with Disabilities	17	30.4	*	*
District	133	34.7	6	1.4
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 23

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Preston School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	32.5
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	2.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	5.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	21.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	1.5
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	3.3
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.0
School Nurses	2.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	33.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	2.0	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	48	98.0	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	6.4	10.4

Instruction and Resources

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	7	*
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	9	*
Other Health Impairment	23	76.7
Other Disabilities	0	0
Speech/Language Impairment	8	*
District	51	69.9
State		68.4

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Preston School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	14	2.5	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	10	1.8	6.1
Other Health Impairment	30	5.3	3.3
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	12	2.1	1.9
All Disabilities	78	13.7	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$8,944,618	\$15,238	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$435,911	\$1,090	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$544,065	\$1,360	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$457,045	\$1,143	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$561,179	\$1,403	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$233,404	\$584	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$792,975	\$1,982	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$773,957	\$1,382	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$170
Total	\$12,743,154	\$21,709	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$977,825	27.7	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$601,229	17.0	10.8
Other Salaries	\$213,484	6.0	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$364,404	10.3	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$314,027	8.9	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$924,288	26.2	22.6
Supplies	\$82,620	2.3	0.6
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$35,945	1.0	6.3
Equipment	\$17,633	0.5	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$3,531,455	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		27.7	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	71.4
State	24.0
Federal	4.3
Tuition & Other	0.3

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Preston School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	8	*	8	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	24	61.0	24	59.7	9	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	11	*	11	*	6	*
White	209	71.7	209	62.0	69	65.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	10	*	10	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	251	70.3	251	61.5	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	74	64.6	74	55.6	27	60.4
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	187	72.7	187	64.4	62	67.8
Students with Disabilities	36	51.4	36	40.2	18	*
Students without Disabilities	225	73.4	225	65.4	71	69.6
High Needs	97	61.7	97	52.9	39	57.2
Non-High Needs	164	75.5	164	67.2	50	72.1
District	261	70.4	261	61.9	89	65.6

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	65.9	82.9	68.8	N/A	133	72.2
Curl Up	27.3	43.9	39.6	N/A	133	36.8
Push Up	54.5	61.0	56.3	N/A	133	57.1
Mile Run/PACER	86.4	92.7	72.9	N/A	133	83.5
All Tests - District	27.3	41.5	37.5	N/A	133	35.3
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Preston School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	70.4	75	46.9	50	93.9	64.2
	High Needs Students	61.7	75	41.1	50	82.3	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	61.9	75	41.3	50	82.6	58.6
	High Needs Students	52.9	75	35.3	50	70.6	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	65.6	75	43.7	50	87.4	61.4
	High Needs Students	57.2	75	38.1	50	76.3	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	69.0%	100%	69.0	100	69.0	60.4%
	High Needs Students	62.8%	100%	62.8	100	62.8	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	54.1%	100%	54.1	100	54.1	65.2%
	High Needs Students	44.0%	100%	44.0	100	44.0	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	64.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	34.7%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	23.7%
	High Needs Students	40.3%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		86.2%	94%	45.9	50	91.7	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		.	75%	.	.	.	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		95.7% 35.3%	75%	23.6	50	47.1	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	52.4%
Accountability Index				545.7	900	60.6	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.7	13.3	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.2	52.9	14.3	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	72.1	57.2	14.9	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.6
	High Needs Students	99.0
Math	All Students	99.6
	High Needs Students	99.0
Science	All Students	100.0
	High Needs Students	100.0

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Preston School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Preston Public Schools is committed to caring for students, family, and staff in the challenging times of COVID-19 and always. We are dedicated to promoting the growth and development of all students. In recent years, the district has made significant progress in various policy redesigns, physical plant remodels, and technology purchases focused on improving student outcomes. Preston established and is approaching the end of a five-year Evergreen Strategic Plan that places student well-being and academic success at the core of its work. The Strategic Plan is being modified to incorporate our equity work and move technology to a top priority, just below our highest priority, student wellness. The district recognizes that without high-quality, fully integrated technology, the district cannot provide the necessary learning experience for teachers and the essential tools to teach our educators. Our new Technology Plan will also have to be modified as we adjust to the demands of providing complete virtual instruction to all students. Also, several student-oriented directives have been issued, the district has laid the groundwork for an in-depth discussion about race, ethnicity, access, and opportunity, and a broad array of policies, procedures, and professional development tasks that emphasize the whole child have been acted on, voted in, or implemented.

Apart from encouraging exemplary performances among students and staff, the district has reinstituted an after-school reading and mathematics program for struggling learners who have been purposefully identified for that intervention. In addition, Preston Public Schools has actively embraced Scientifically Based Research Intervention and its behavioral counterpart, Positive Behavioral Support Intervention, to drive academic success. Preston is a participant in a national conversation with educational leaders on implementing a comprehensive Social Emotional Learning strategy and has established an internal Social Emotional Equity Learning Team (SEEL Team).

The adoption of formative assessment programs such as Direct Reading Assessments, STAR Assessment, and Smarter Balanced Individual Assessment Blocks has helped create a data-based examination of how to assess student competency and develop appropriate instructional approaches in response to the results obtained from those assessments.

We have used the strategies and priorities noted above to establish an innovative summer school partnership with Mystic Seaport to provide support to students and ready them with the skills and knowledge to be prepared for school each year. The district has also established "Kitchen Table Talk" type of small group parent meetings to connect to the voices of families. The Board of Education has set as a priority to communicate with parents in alignment with ESSER, Title I, and strategic planning goals. The superintendent is in the process of visiting our partner high schools to assess the voices of secondary students who have left our district and gone on to high school.

Lastly, communication tools such as the community Pipeline, which is distributed throughout town, the superintendent's Facebook page, and the use of Blackboard Connect, email blasts, the Remind App, newspaper articles, surveys, and student-based activities all assist in maintaining and improving school district messaging to the community.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Preston Public Schools are embedded in a small, relatively homogenous but changing community of just under 5,000 people. The school district population PK-8 is comprised of about 430 students. Preston also cares for approximately 200 high school students that attend surrounding institutions. The district employs various strategies designed to reduce racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. In years past, we established a community group whose charge is to look deeply into race, access, and opportunity. This community group is being reestablished after COVID disruption. We are engaged with the LEARN Collaborative and its offering: Race, Racism, Equity presentation by Dr. Lee Teitel. The leadership of the district is involved in a text-based discussion using two books: "The Fire Next Time," by James Baldwin, "White Fragility, Why it's so hard for white people to talk about racism," by Robin Diangelo, "Me and white supremacy: Combat Racism, Change the World, and Become a Good Ancestor" by Layla F. Saad. We use the Equity Tool Kit established by the Connecticut Department of Education for reference and guidance. We also signed up as a district for access to Yale University's Center for Emotional Intelligence, including Dr. Mark Brackett's offer for multiple virtual course offerings on various mental health issues. We engaged Safe Future's professional development and engaged partners such as Effective School Solutions to assist learning staff in addressing mental health, student and staff wellness, and student self-regulating behavior. And we are in the process of reviewing our Strategic Plan to incorporate what we are learning into our future planning.

At the building levels, all students at the middle school level participate in an Advisor-Advisee program. This program provides a supervised venue for discussing various topics, including racial, ethnic, religious, and economic differences.

At the PK -5 level, the school's annual Preston Palooza, Annual Food Drive, and support of various charities such as the American Cancer Society is an event that engages virtually every student in appreciating the needs of those who are economically challenged and less fortunate. Lastly, both schools offer one or more assemblies throughout the year that are designed to enlighten.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Preston School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Every effort is made to equalize the distribution of resources through the budgetary process. We are a small enough district that we can track dollars to the classroom, library, specialist rooms, and, in some cases, directly to specific students. This helps us assure equitable distribution of resources. Several budget process innovations include business case defense of innovation, "acceptable risk," student-based budget allocation, and budget linkage to the strategic plan. The district has created several tracking documents linked to the strategic plan, including a student count and program matching document, a chart that tracks year-to-year spending called the Rainbow Chart, and a line-by-line analysis document. These processes help to assure equity in the distribution of resources. A collaborative approach to budget planning is required. It includes the entire leadership team, the building level administrators, the central office, and coordination with the First Selectwoman as a budget planning team member. Budgetary decisions are based upon curriculum initiatives, safety and security priorities, staff and family, wellbeing, community standards, expectations, and student need.